

Build text adventures that play in a terminal, a browser, or anywhere in between.

JACL is a small, interpreted programming language for writing interactive fiction. Its standard library does the heavy lifting — the parser, the world model, 216 ready-built verbs — so the author can focus on the writing.

This is the authoritative reference, taking you from your first room to a finished game ready to publish online.

INSIDE

- A complete tutorial game, walked through step by step
- The full object, location, attribute and grammar reference
- The web interface library for browser play — with auto-save, voice synthesis and a clickable command bar
- Multimedia, menus, CSV-backed data and timed events
- Three appendices: every attribute, every library verb, and the source code for the tutorial game

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Stuart Allen has been writing and maintaining JACL since 1992. The interpreter and its libraries are free software, distributed under the GNU General Public License.

JACL Interpreter v4.7 · github.com/DangarStu/JACL
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EIGHTH EDITION

The JACL Author's Guide

STUART ALLEN

```
location bedroom : master bedroom
west             bathroom
south            nowhere

look
print:
  You are in your bedroom. There is
  a large, soft bed in the centre
  of the room while a doorway to the
  west leads into the bathroom.
  -
  write "To the south there is "
  if door has CLOSED
    write "closed"
  else
    write "open"
  endif
  write " door.^\n"
}

movement
if compass = south
  if destination = nowhere
    write "The bedroom door
    is closed.^\n"
    return true
  endif
endif
return false

object bed: bed
short      a "bed"
mass       scenery

look_under
if guide(parent) = limbo
  write "Hidden under the bed you
  find this week's television guide.^\n"
  set guide(parent) = here
  points 50
  return
endif
write "You don't find anything else.^\n"

object guide: television tv tele guide
short      a "television guide"
long       "The television guide
is here.^\n"
parent     limbo
mass       5
```

JACL

ADVENTURE CREATION LANGUAGE

Author's Guide

THE DEFINITIVE GUIDE TO WRITING
INTERACTIVE FICTION WITH JACL



**POWERFUL
SCRIPTING**
A flexible, expressive
language for all
types of adventures.



**IMMERSIVE
WORLDS**
Bring your stories
to life with rich
locations, objects
and logic.



**BUILD
ANYTHING**
From simple tales
to complex, branching
epics.



**COMPLETE
REFERENCE**
Everything you need
to master JACL.